Lab Activity: Comparing Two Apps

Name: John Carlo Gabadal
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1. Test Setup

Domain Chosen: Messaging Apps

Platform A: Messenger (Mobile App)

Platform B: Telegram (Mobile App)

User Task Goal: Create a new group chat, add two contacts, and name it "Study Group."

2. Information Architecture (IA) & Task Flow

Messenger Path:

Home → Tap the New Chat icon (top right) → Tap "Create a Group" → Select 2 contacts → Tap Next → Type "Study Group" → Tap Create.

Telegram Path:

Home → Tap the pencil icon (bottom right) → Tap "New Group" → Select 2 contacts → Tap Next → Type "Study Group" → Tap the checkmark to finish.

Task Flow Comparison

Metric	Messenger	Telegram
Total Taps	5 taps	6 taps
Time to Complete	~12 seconds	~18 seconds
Pop-ups / Extra Screens	None	1 (permission prompt for adding members)

3. Comparative HCI Matrix

Criterion	Messenger	Telegram	Winner
Simplicity	**4/5** Clean home screen, but the group-creation icon is small and easy to miss.	**4.5/5** Large, clearly labeled pencil icon; group setup screen has few distractions.	Telegram
Consistency	**4/5** Icons and colors match across chats, but the group-naming step looks different from a normal 1-on-1 chat.	**4.5/5** Same layout and icon style is used for every chat type, including groups.	Telegram
Feedback	**3.5/5**	**4/5**	Telegram

Criterion	Messenger	Telegram	Winner
	Group appears in the chat list right away, but there is no confirmation message.	Shows a short 'Group created' system message inside the new chat.	
Learnability & User Control	**4/5** Easy to rename or leave the group later; the back button works as expected at every step.	**4/5** Also easy to edit later, though the permission pop-up may confuse first-time users.	Tie

4. Final Verdict & UX Recommendations

Better: Telegram

Key Reason for Winning:

Telegram keeps the group-creation icon large and visible, confirms the action with a clear message, and uses one consistent layout for every type of chat. This makes the task faster to complete and easier to learn for a new user.

Recommendations for Messenger (The Losing Platform):

- Issue 1 — Low Icon Visibility: The New Chat icon is small and easy to overlook on first use.
- Fix (Simplicity): Make the icon larger or add a short text label such as "New" next to it.
- Issue 2 — Missing Confirmation: Users get no message telling them the group was created successfully.
- Fix (Feedback): Show a brief on-screen message like "Group created!" right after the group is made.
- Issue 3 — Extra Step to Rename: Users must open group settings separately to change the group photo, adding unnecessary taps.
- Fix (Learnability & User Control): Let users set a group photo on the same screen where they type the group name.